

Acer Aspire 5

Is this the best Windows laptop under ₹60,000?

Upon writing this Acer Aspire 5 review, I have a confession to make.

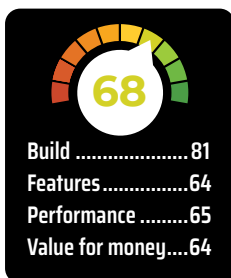
On one hand, I so long for a work/mainstream laptop that has good I/O support, high build quality, a great keyboard and trackpad combination, and a capable yet power-efficient processor. On the other hand, whenever I use such a device as my daily driver, especially when considering it as a contender for the best laptop under Rs 60,000, I am starkly reminded why these laptops cost so less. There's always one or the other thing that's not the way it should be and more often than not, it breaks my heart and my hopes. Regardless, here's the Acer Aspire 5 review that'll tell you exactly whether and who should buy the laptop.

DESIGN, BUILD QUALITY, KEYBOARD AND I/O

In all the areas mentioned above, the Acer Aspire 5 easily excels or at least is above average. Starting with the build quality, the laptop's polycarbonate-metal body is durable, sleek, and minimalist. Two things you definitely want in a work laptop with the third one being a bonus. The laptop's lid is made out of metal meanwhile its deck area is made from polycarbonate. Both feature the same shade of grey, at least in the case of my review unit which is grey in colour.

The rather thick bezels around the display are made out of black polycarbonate, further giving the laptop a dual-tone look. Speaking of looks, the laptop is very minimalist-looking despite featuring the company branding in more than one area. But all

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of it is done very cleverly so it doesn't become annoying. Although you get a proprietary charger with the laptop you can easily switch to a USB type-C charging brick, thanks to the on-board Thunderbolt 4 port, to go along with the laptop.

Moving on to the keyboard it is a full-size one as it includes a numpad. The volume, and brightness adjustment keys on the keyboard are shared with the function keys but it is easy to switch between them. The keys have slightly rounded corners and are tactile. Although there is no mention of the official key travel anywhere, I feel it is somewhere between 1 to 1.1 mm. Needless to say, it is inoffensive but it could be better. I personally prefer 60% keyboards but I could see why a numpad would bring happiness and joy in your life. Especially if you're someone who spends his days Microsoft Excel and Google Sheets a lot, lord bless your soul.

Moving on to the trackpad and I am as surprised as you are while saying this is of high quality. It is properly installed and with that I mean it is at an even

level. Both the left and right click on the laptop press down at the same level too. In short, the trackpad is very symmetrical and feels to have no inherent quality issue. But I can't comment on its long-term durability. Still, I have a hunch that it will take the future wear and tear quite well.

The I/O, as I mentioned in the specification section is high in quality if not quantity. It comes with an HDMI 2.1 port, meaning it can power an external 4K Monitor at 120FPS, which is very handy if you're a "dual monitor guy," and because of one more reason about which I will talk in the display section of this review. Acer Aspire 5 also has a USB 3.2 port, a USB port with power-off charging, a USB Type-C Thunderbolt 4 port, and a headphone-mic combo.

SCREEN AND SPEAKERS REVIEW

The thing that really puts me off from the Acer Aspire 5 is its display. It lacks in many significant and non-significant areas which really doesn't encourage you to buy the laptop. Firstly, the laptop's display has a very low peak brightness. At a mere 182 nits, the laptop's display is very dim. Furthermore, the display panel's viewing angles are also not good.

Secondly, the screen is very colour inaccurate with an average Delta E value of 12.4. For reference, in colour-accurate displays, this figure is usually less than 3. Not only does the screen shows inaccurate colours it doesn't even show as many of them with just 58.5% sRGB and 43.1% DCI-P3 colour space coverage. One good thing about the display is its size, which is 15.6 inches, and the anti-glare coating on its surface.

The speakers too are kind of "mid." Not many laptops nail the speaker setup in the Rs 50,000 to 60,000 price range, so I am not surprised. But, I do think that with the screen being a letdown, at least the speakers could have been better. To summarise, get a pair of headphones too if you get the laptop.

PERFORMANCE

Alright, the Acer Aspire 5 leaves no room